CHANGE THE WORLD

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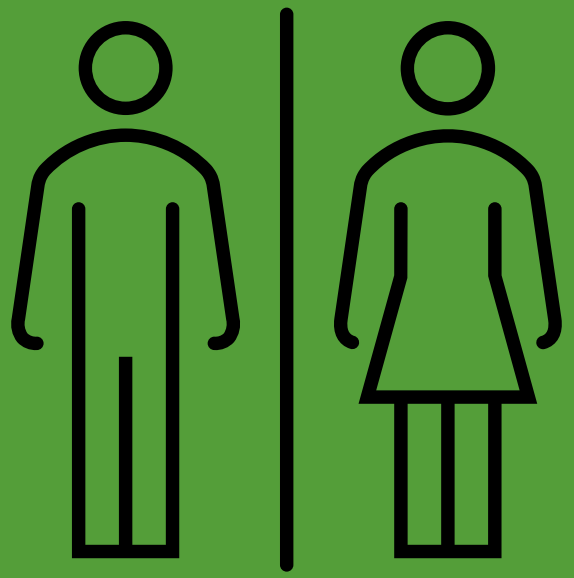


Gender-role stereotypes

One of the most under looked issues in our society is the normalization of inaccurate stereotypes *we* placed on genders. Both perspectives suffer from not only the stereotype itself, but the long going affects it creates. Affects such as, ineffective coping mechanism, lack of opportunities, and inequality amongst opposite sex can occur. To resolve this problem, it must be a societal group effort to help unlearn what we have mad ‘acceptable’. If we choose not to change for the better, then our problem will only get worst.

“Men Don’t Cry”

Men are told these phrases as such throughout their entire lives. Society pushes men to suppress their emotions by using words like “toughen up” or “man up”. Due to the traditional behavior men are expected to be, they commonly mistake vulnerability to weakness. This stereotype causes most men to develop long lasting affects, which falls into toxic masculinity.

Consequences

- Mental health: Can cause unhealthy habits and develop disorders such and depression or anxiety
- Isolation: Most men will push loved ones away when they are struggling, leading to loneliness
- Aggression: Bottled emotions can create violent breakdowns either to themselves or/and others

Personal role & attributions

Growing up with 4 brothers, I visually could see how differently society expected us to behave. I can say there were times where people underestimated my skills due to me being girl, which is unfair. Honestly, everyone may not want to change these gender roles, but as someone who is empathic to both perspectives, I want to help change how we view each other. I believe everyone deserves to be treated with care and respect regardless of their situation. With sports, I gained more experience in inclusivity and teamwork. I can use those skills to help advocate for the unfair expectations.

HOW TO FIX THIS

Educating yourself/peers: First step is to see the problem and understand the cause and effects

Making safe environments: Allowing people to have a place where they feel nurtured to help regulate their feelings

Reveal authentic self: Becoming a role model in expressing yourself in a healthy manner shows younger generations that it is okay to have emotions

Speak up: when seeing inappropriate behavior, step in and advocate for what is right

“WOMEN ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR HOUSEHOLD MAINTENANCE”

In many societies, women have traditionally been expected to manage the home. Responsibilities included cooking, cleaning, and organizing family life, this was often labeled as the "homemaker" role. This expectation limits women's opportunities to pursue careers, education, or other interests.

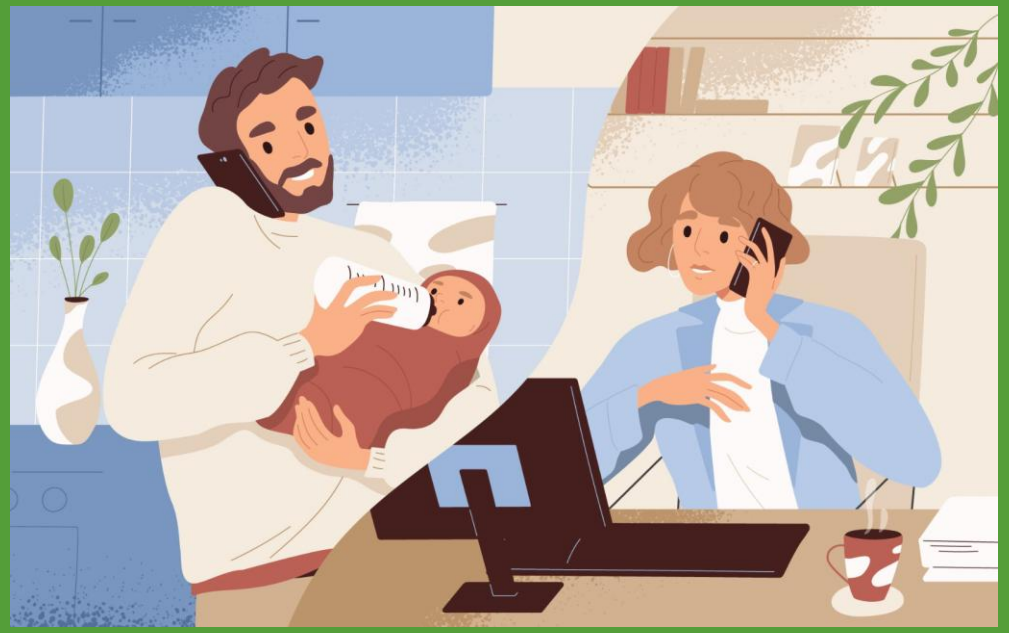
Consequences

- **Limits Career Growth**: Many women still face pressure to handle domestic duties, which can limit career and educational advancement.
- **Mental Health**: Can lead to stress and burnout as they juggle multiple roles without sufficient support.
- **Gender Equality**: Sustains gender inequality, as unpaid domestic work is undervalued in society.

Personal role & attribution

Growing up, I have noticed the pressure that many traditional gender roles, like household management, can place on women. As a female student-athlete, I've seen how gender roles influence expectations in sports, especially in leadership and teamwork roles. I've seen moments where women in sports are often overlooked or expected to take on certain roles based on gender. This topic is important to me because I believe that everyone, regardless of gender, should have an equal role overall, and no one should feel confined to a specific set of expectations based on their gender.

How to fix this



Encourage Shared Responsibilities: Advocate for equal sharing of household tasks within families.

Educational Initiatives: Promote awareness about the value of shared roles in schools and communities.

Policy Advocacy: Support policies that provide better childcare and parental leave options, easing the burden on women.

Corporate Responsibility: Encourage workplaces to support work-life balance for all employees, including flexible hours and family leave policies

”Men can’t wear that”

Even with the drastic changes the current generation has made, majority of our world still believes there are strict guidelines as to what a man should or shouldn’t wear/do. It is a common belief that clothes are ‘only’ gender-based from factors such as type of color, length, and style. These factors limits men to naturally explore other wardrobe options. However, as society grows, unisex clothes have become a popular category, when it comes to dress attire. Now, as years go by, people get more comfortable with seeing men freely express themselves in untraditional clothes.

Consequence:

- **Low Self-Esteem**: Many males believe they can’t be who they truly want to be without someone lecturing them on formulated guidelines our society has

PERSONAL ROLE AND ATTRIBUTION

Growing up in a Caribbean household, seeing males wear things females usually wear was not normal. However, as I went to school and came across certain situations in life, it wasn't something that I thought was unusual. I grew up with an uncle who wore nail polish on his nail but was still masculine. He was not gay, that was just his style. I've also had friends who enjoyed wearing things that people would categorize as feminine.

How to fix this

Stop judging: Allow people to do as they please, fashion does not need a gender attached to it!

Soon to be 2025!: As a community, we are no longer in the 50's, stop viewing the world like we are.

Self aware: Projecting your insecurities are never the answer, find inner acceptance, to see the beauty of others

“WOMEN ARE SO EMOTIONAL”

The stereotype that women are more emotional than men has been pervasive in many societies for centuries, rooted in cultural, historical, and even pseudoscientific beliefs (falsely or mistakenly claimed or regarded as being based on scientific method). This stereotype often portrays women as being more sensitive, nurturing, or prone to emotional expression than men. While several factors contribute to this idea, it's important to recognize that it's largely a social construct rather than an inherent truth. As we continue to break gendered stereotypes, we realize that women are not inherently "more emotional" than men; rather, both genders experience emotions deeply but may express them differently.

Breaking the stereotype

Research on biological differences between men and women has not supported the stereotype that women are inherently more emotional. While hormones like estrogen and oxytocin are linked to empathy and bonding and are more prevalent in women, these differences do not automatically result in heightened emotional sensitivity. Studies show that men and women generally experience emotions with similar intensity, but societal expectations shape how these emotions are expressed. For example, while women might more readily express sadness, men may more readily express anger or aggression.

Personal role & Attribution

- Growing up in a home with majority of boys, I have noticed that not only am I not more emotional than them, but they tend to express their emotions even more than I do. So, that got me thinking, am I **less** emotional than other women, or does society have it all wrong?
- As a female student-athlete pursuing a career in a field dominated by men, this issue is very important to me. For decades women have been perceived as less capable because they're inherently "more emotional" than men. This causes people to think we may act out of impulse and being incapable or less capable of doing jobs than men; further perpetuating the idea that women need to be kept in the house with the children rather than working and making big decisions. I, however, do not want to be kept in the house with the kids and want equal opportunity based on my qualifications rather than my gender.

How to fix this

- promote emotional education
- challenge stereotypes in media and pop culture
- encourage open discussions about emotions for all genders
- encourage equal treatment and opportunity in professional environments
- redefine emotionality as a strength rather than a weakness

ROLE OF COLLEGE

As student athletes we are exposed to a variety of different personalities and structures. Most of the time we are presented as ‘role models’ so, we should take advantage of that title and encourage our peers/classmates to be apart of a focus that impacts all of us. Some engaging ways we can do in college that cater to our concerns are:

- Finding a sponsorship that helps bring awareness to gender-role stereotypes
- Joining clubs that challenge your inner thoughts
- Taking advantage of the mental wellness department
- Taking an elective to get more insight about this topic (gender studies/modern masculinity/global women’s studies)
- Having/joining support groups

THE END